

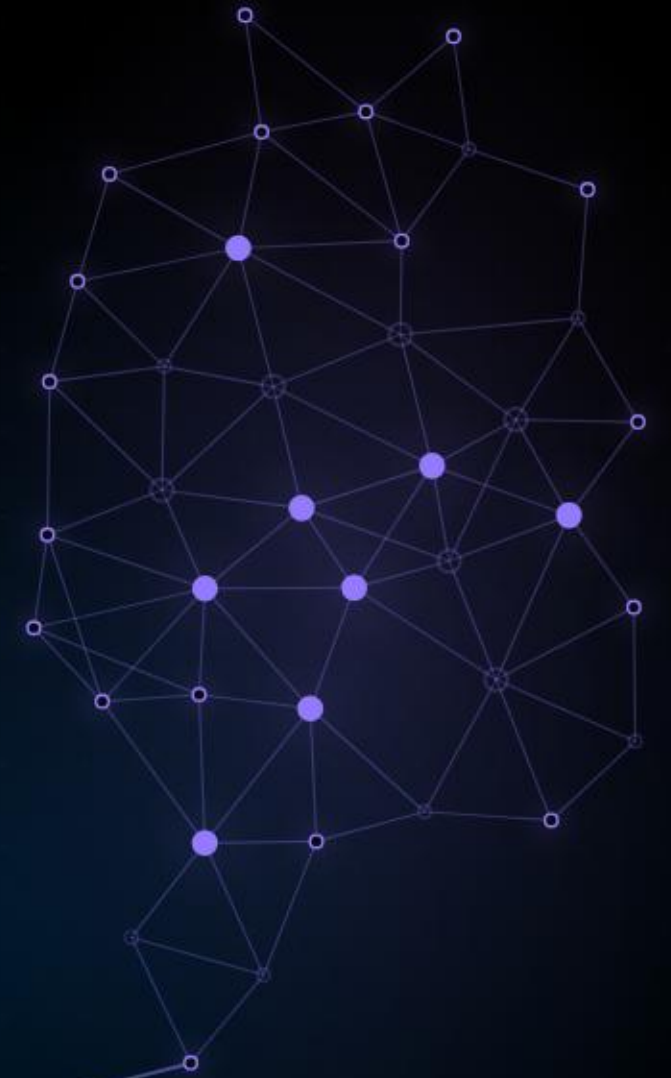


• AI SUMMIT BARCELONA 2026 • WORKSHOP

Building your Second Brain

Leave this room with a personal knowledge base you can use during this conference, and take back to your job.

Maxime "MadMax" Gaudin • CTO, Gladia | 80 min • Hands-on





— SPEAKER FILE · 001

Maxime "MadMax" Gaudin



CTO AT GLADIA

Speaking today, building live

— BACKGROUND

14+ years in tech. Groupe SEB, then Malt (10 → 200 people), co-founded Matcha (raised €2.1M), CTO at MadKudu (acquired by HGInsights)

— AT GLADIA

Since November 2025. Leading a 20-person engineering team building the voice AI platform

— BASED IN

Alsace, France



Gladi

Speech-to-text API · real-time & async transcription, 100+ languages



Gladia

AI AUDIO INFRASTRUCTURE

One API to record, transcribe and enrich audio. Solaria-3 handles 100+ languages and switches mid-sentence, under 300ms in real time, on EU infrastructure. The company I work for, and the reason I am here today.

300K+

DEVELOPERS

100+

LANGUAGES, LIVE

<300ms

REAL-TIME LATENCY

Meeting assistants

Contact centers

Voice agents

Content & media



— THE DEAL

You will leave this room with **superpowers**

If the next slide doesn't excite you, leave. Go to another session. No hard feelings, I'll grab a coffee.

Build the best presentation in your company



Juggle 20+ communication sources without breaking a sweat



Write the best report you have ever seen



YOUR SECOND BRAIN



Answer any question about your company, your team, anything anyone ever did, in a minute



Get a personalized podcast every morning



Craft your own superpowers for your own problems



CHAPTER 01

My Story

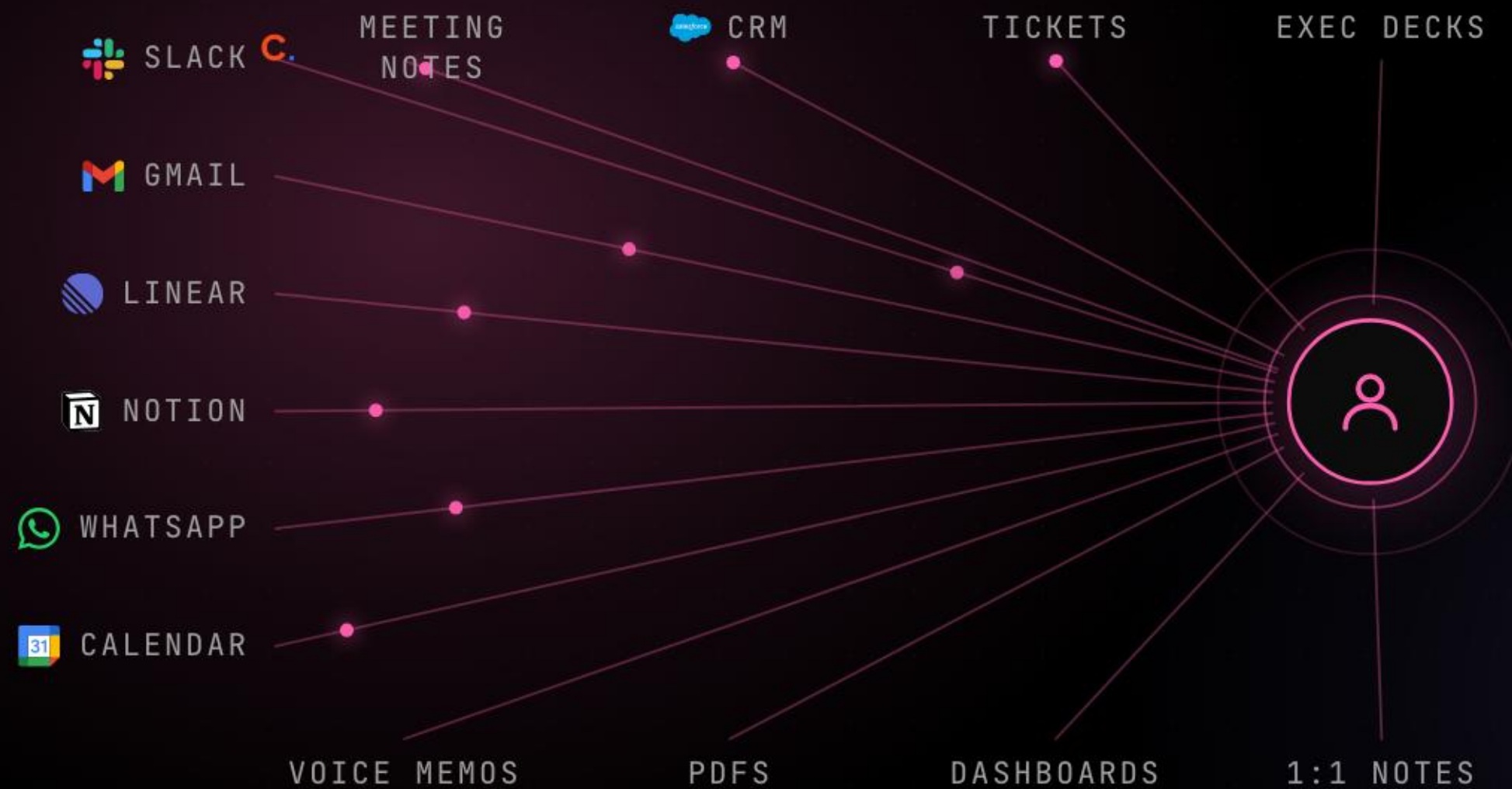
November 2025. New company, 20+ information sources, and no idea where anything was.





— NOVEMBER 2025 · FIRST WEEKS

I joined Gladia as CTO and **drowned**



20+

INFORMATION SOURCES

None of them talking to each other.



— THE WRONG ANSWER

So I tried working 15 hours a day

9H LEFT

Sleep, family, everything else.



ENERGY LEFT IN THE TANK



◆ I wasn't choosing to work 15 hours. I was just struggling to keep up. **Like a dumbass.** And the more tired I got, the less each hour was worth.



— THE REAL PROBLEM

I spent my days **filtering** instead of thinking



THE INTEGRATION LAYER WAS ME

WHAT THE JOB NEEDED

Reading the situation, **deciding**, giving the team a direction.

WHAT THE DAY ACTUALLY WAS

Slack, then mail, then Linear, then the meeting recording, then back to Slack.
Filtering noise from signal by hand, in every single channel, every single day.



THE TURNING POINT

Full remote was the **cheat code**

01

Full remote

Nothing happens in a hallway. No corridor decision, no whiteboard I forget by Friday.

02

So everything is recorded

Threads, emails, meeting transcripts, tickets, documents. All of it already written down, somewhere.

03

And recorded means readable

If a machine can read every one of those interactions, a machine can act on them.

THE AHA MOMENT

What if I built a system that ingested every one of those interactions — and let agents handle the mundane part of my job?



— MY ACTUAL RESPONSIBILITIES

Almost all of it can be **automated**

01	Collect	Read everything: Slack, mail, tickets, meeting recordings, dashboards	AUTOMATABLE
02	Track	Know where every project, risk and deadline actually stands	AUTOMATABLE
03	Produce	Briefs, decks, reviews, post-mortems, reports, follow-up emails	AUTOMATABLE
04	Relay	Updates, reminders, nudges — keeping twenty people aligned	AUTOMATABLE
05	Decide	Strategy, trade-offs, architecture, people. Judgement on incomplete data	THIS IS THE JOB



— THE CAVEAT

Some things you **never** automate



ME



SOMEONE ON MY TEAM

1:1s

Thirty minutes where the only agenda is the person sitting in front of me.

Growing people

Feedback, coaching, career moves. Honestly, the part of the job I enjoy the most.

Hard conversations

Bad news, conflict, disagreement. You show up and deliver those yourself.



— THE DECISION

I created a **second brain**

COMMUNICATION

Meeting notes, recordings, emails, WhatsApp, Slack

WORK TOOLS

Linear tickets, documents, presentations

BUSINESS

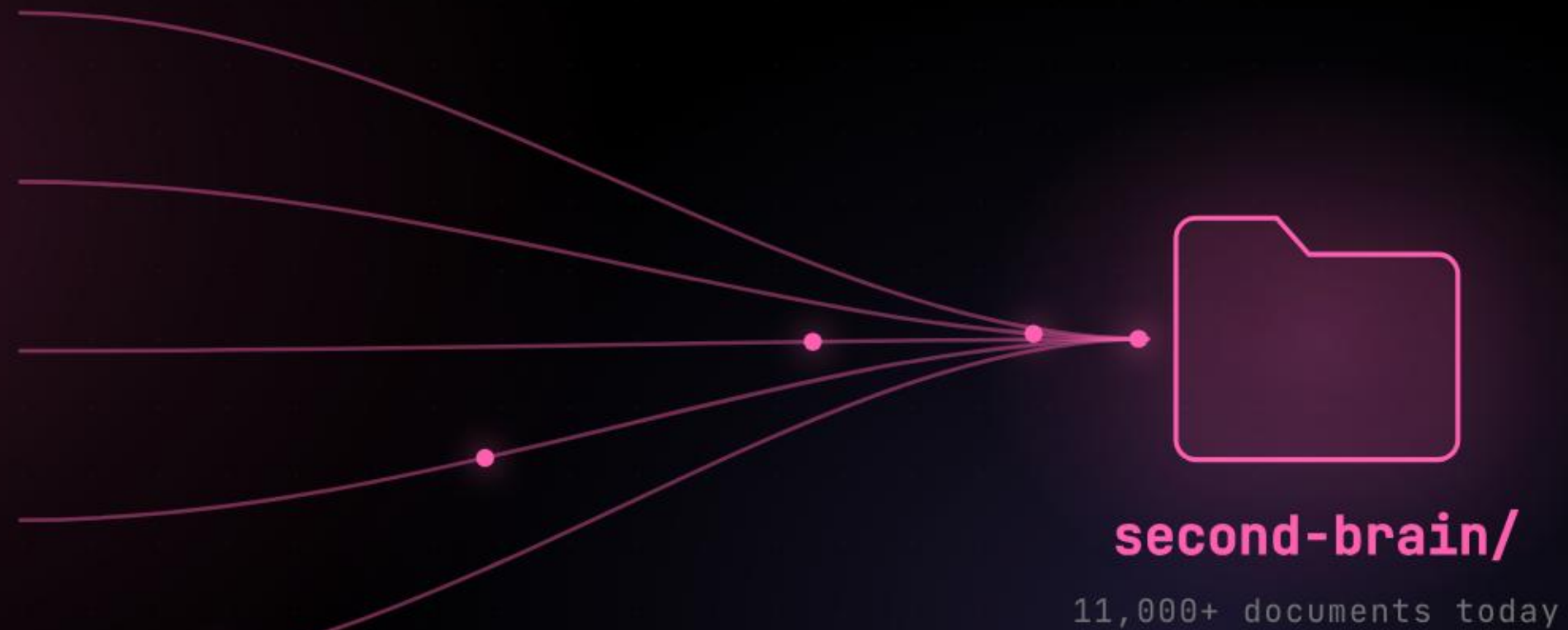
Business results, CRM records, deal notes

PEOPLE

HR files, QPRs, people notes, org charts

STRATEGY

Weekly & quarterly decks, exec committee



◆ One rule: **every professional interaction lands in this folder.** Not surveillance. The only way to survive the volume.



— ANATOMY OF A SECOND BRAIN

Four Parts. One Brain.

01 Raw Inputs FEEDS THE BRAIN

Immutable raw material. Never changes once captured.

emails · meeting notes · messages · voice memos
· documents · PDFs

03 Tools FEEDS THE BRAIN

Live connections that feed your inputs and your knowledge.

   CRM · web search

02 Knowledge COMES BACK OUT

Everything generated from your inputs, by you or by the AI.

analyses · summaries · decision records ·
people files · project briefs

04 Skills INSTRUCTS THE BRAIN

The manual you write for the AI. How to do a task your way.

meeting follow-up · daily inbox routine ·
presentation builder

THE AI MODEL



the reasoning brain

Four folders and one model. That is the entire thing. **You are building exactly this before you leave the room.**



— WHAT THAT LOOKS LIKE ON DISK

Six folders. That is the whole architecture.

second-brain · explorer

second-brain/	one folder. that is the whole product.
└─ me/	who you are, your role, your goals
└─ team/	colleagues, what each of them owns
└─ notes/	meeting notes, voice memos, raw capture
└─ initiatives/	every active project lives here
└─ processes/	how things actually get done
└─ contacts/	people you meet, starting today

INSIDE INITIATIVES/

An initiative is one time-bound project, carrying its own sources, knowledge and outputs.

initiatives/

└─ barcelona-summit/

└─ **sources/** raw material in

└─ **knowledge/** what you and the AI write

└─ **output/** what you actually ship



QUESTIONS



Before we go hands-on, anything on your mind?

NEXT: YOU BUILD YOUR OWN





— OPEN THIS NOW, AND LEAVE THE TAB OPEN

Everything we build today is **already written down.**

 **github.com/MaximeGaudin/second-brain-starter**

bootstrap-prompt.md

The prompt that builds your folder, in one paste.

skills/

Every skill we write today, finished and working.

me/tone-of-voice.md

The file that makes it write like you and not like me.



— BEFORE WE START

One tool today. **Cursor.**



cursor.com/download

One download, and all four of these are already true. That is the only reason we picked it.



Obsidian and Claude can be made to do the same thing, and so can a few others. Today everybody runs the same stack, so nobody spends the hour debugging a different one.

WHAT THE TOOL MUST DO



Edits plain files on your own machine

The brain is a folder of markdown. No database, no proprietary format, nothing to migrate out of later.



An agent that opens that folder itself

Not a chat window you paste into. It has to read and write the files without you ferrying text back and forth.



Standing instructions it actually follows

One place to write down how you work, so you are not re-explaining yourself at the start of every session.



Connects to where your work already lives

Mail, chat, calendar, notes. A brain you have to feed by hand stays empty by Thursday.



CHAPTER 02

Build Yours

Laptops open. Setup first, then one superpower at a time.





— SETUP · STEP 1 OF 5

Download Cursor. That is **the whole step.**

 cursor.com/download

macOS

Mac (ARM64)

Apple Silicon. Take Mac (x64) only if your Mac is from before 2021.

Windows

Windows (x64) · User

The User installer needs no admin rights, which matters on a locked-down laptop.

Linux

.deb · .rpm · AppImage

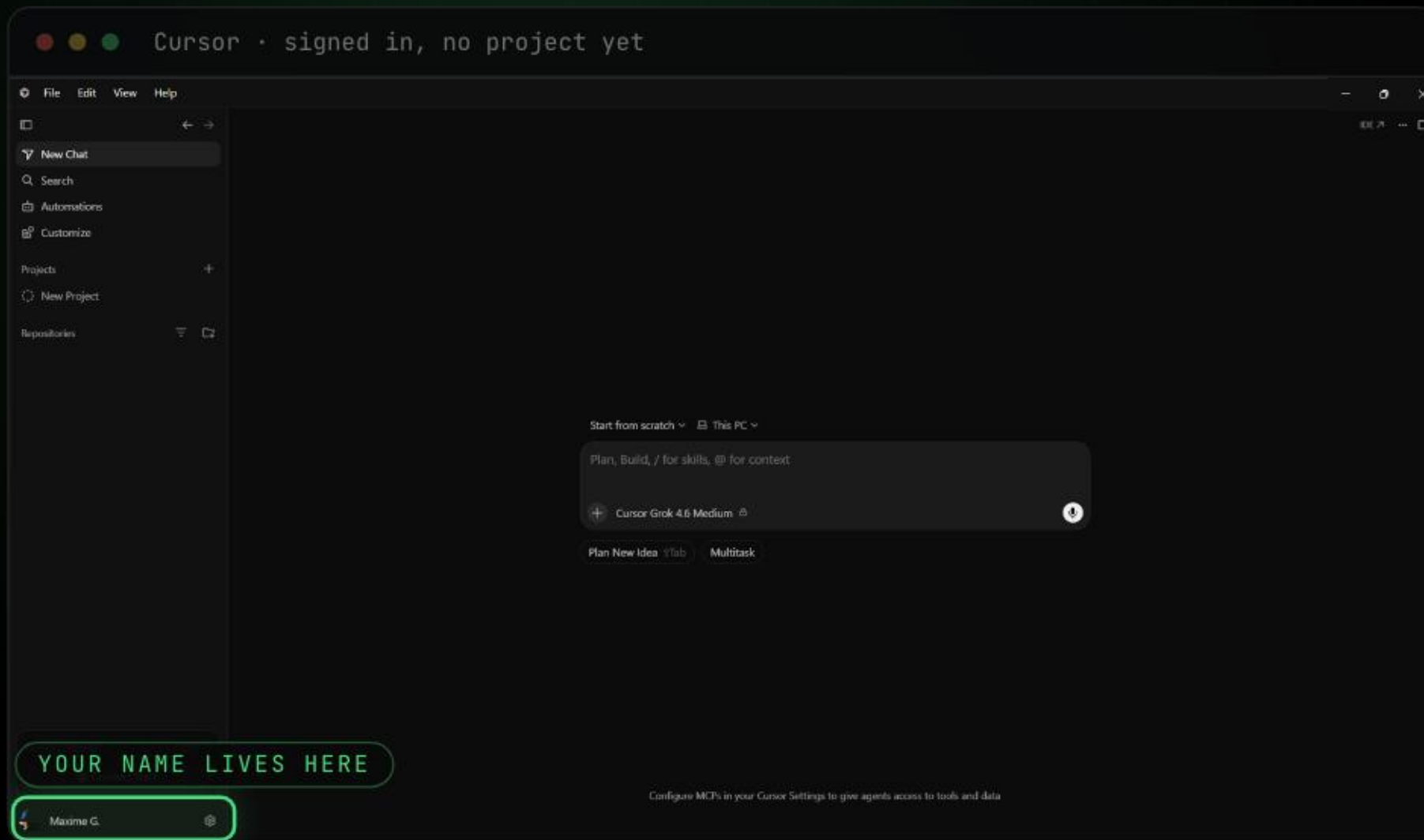
Whichever your distro prefers. AppImage runs without installing anything.

Then open it, accept every default, and skip the tour. Importing your VS Code settings can wait, or never happen. Roughly 200 MB, so start the download now and listen while it runs.



— SETUP · STEP 2 OF 5

Sign in. Check **your name** is in the corner.



1 Create an account or sign in

Cursor opens on a sign-in screen. Google, GitHub or an email address — take whichever you will still remember in six months.

2 Approve it in the browser tab

A tab opens, you click approve, it closes itself and hands you back to the app. Nothing to copy or paste.

3 Confirm bottom-left

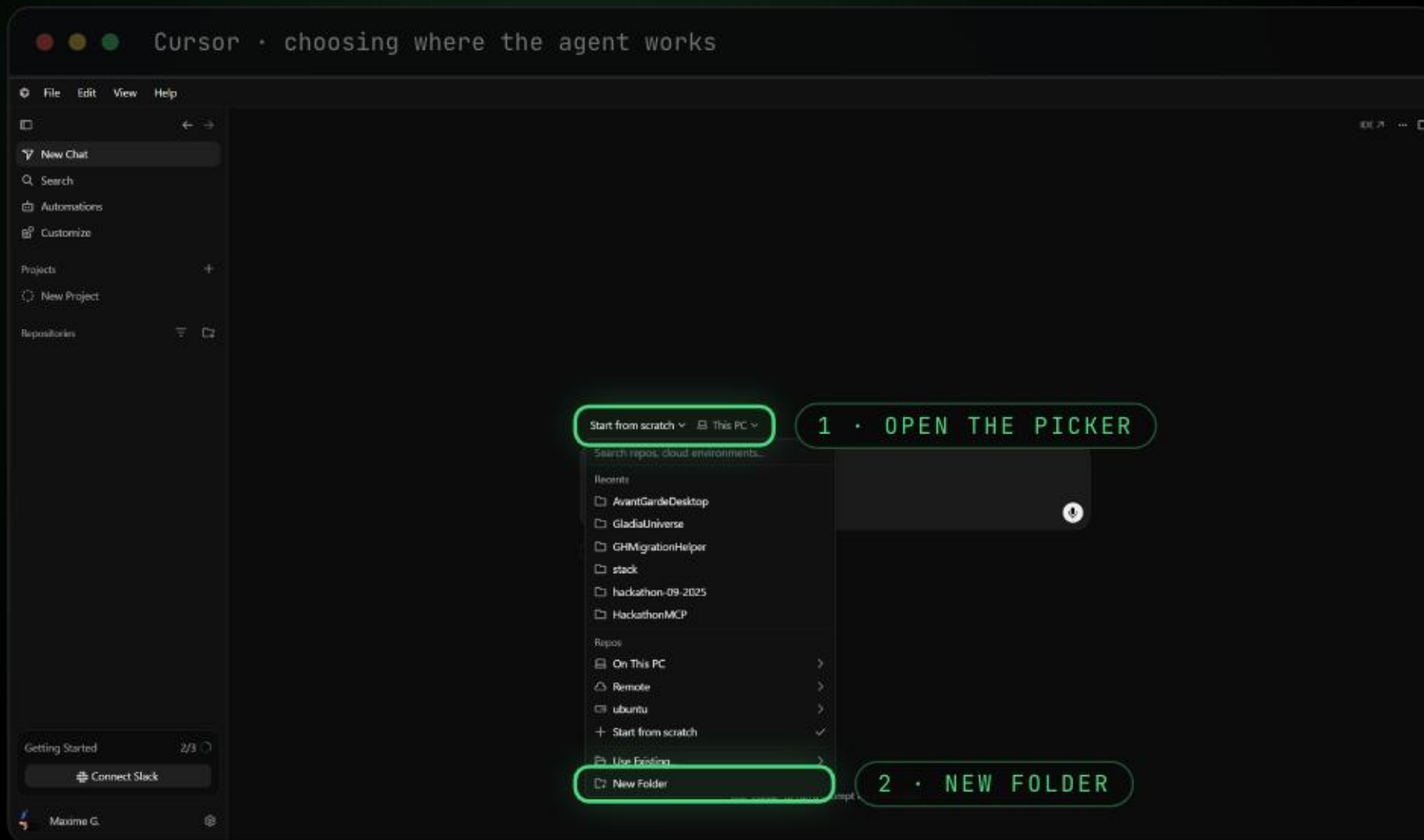
Your name sits at the bottom of the sidebar. That is the only confirmation there is, and it is enough.

The free tier covers everything we do today — no card, no trial to start. If the browser tab hangs, close it and press sign in again; it is almost always a stale session, not you.



— SETUP · STEP 3 OF 5

Create **one empty folder**. Call it **second-brain**.



1 Open the folder picker

Just above the chat box, next to Start from scratch. It lists your recent folders, your repos and the machines it can reach.

2 Choose New Folder

Bottom of the list. Not a repo, not a cloud environment — a plain folder on this laptop.

3 Name it second-brain

Put it somewhere you will find again by accident. Documents is fine. Desktop is fine. A folder nested nine levels deep is not.

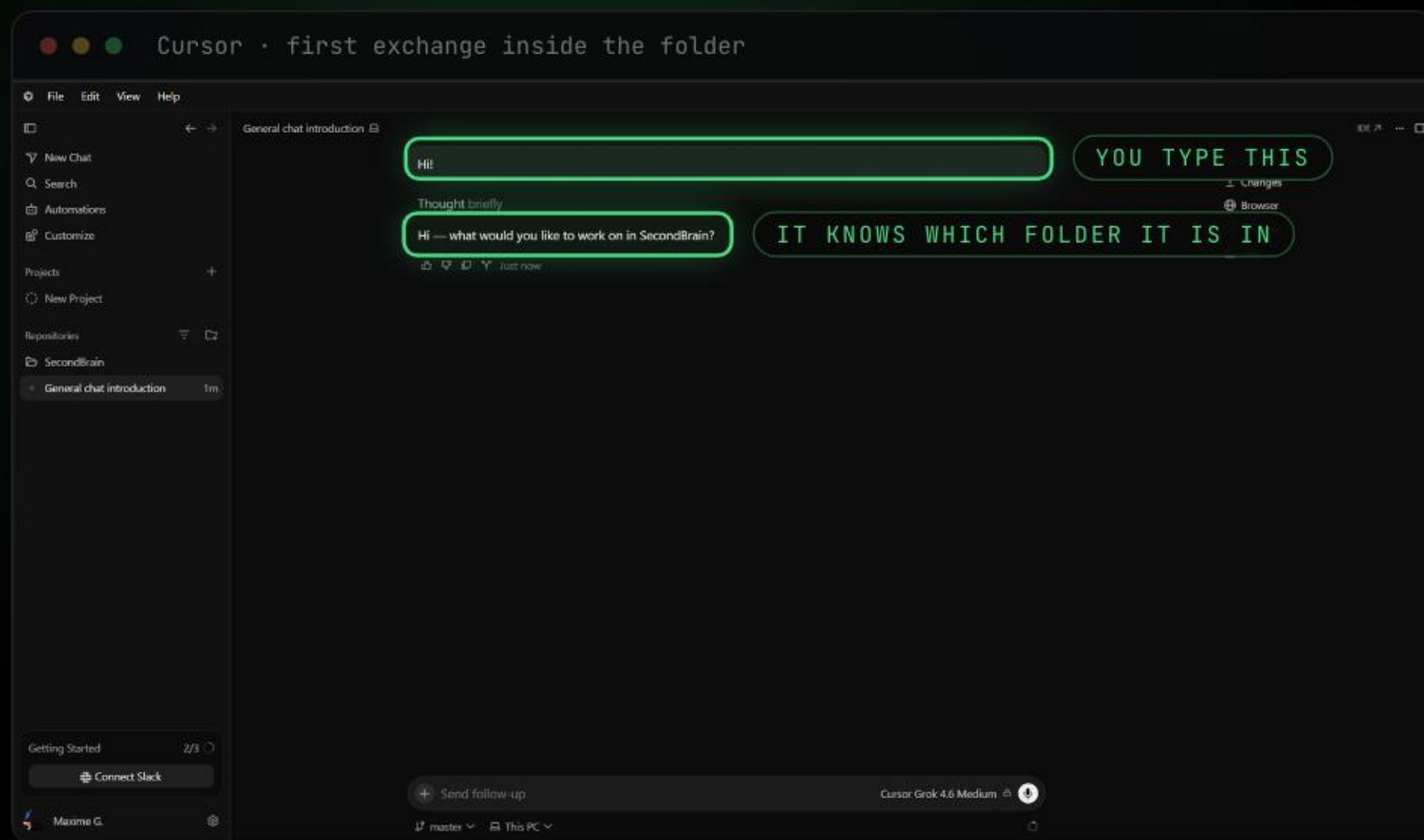
4 Expect it to be empty

Cursor reopens on that folder with nothing in it. That is correct. Everything from here fills it up.



— SETUP · STEP 4 OF 5

Say hi. Setup is done **when it answers.**



1 Type Hi! and press enter

Two characters. This is not the moment to test it with something clever.

2 Read the answer carefully

It greets you back and names your folder. That name is the proof it is looking at your project and not at nothing.

3 You are set up

An agent is running on your machine, inside a folder you own. Everything left today is deciding what to put in it.

No answer after ten seconds, or an error about a model? Check the model selector at the bottom of the chat box and pick any of the ones offered. Still nothing — flag it, your neighbour and I will get you running while the next slide plays.



One prompt builds the whole thing.

paste this into the chat box

5 STEPS · ~130 LINES

Set up my second brain in this folder. Work through the five steps in order, and do not skip step 3.

STEP 1 – Build the structure

Create these folders, each with a .gitkeep file so they survive being empty:

me/	who I am, my role, my goals
team/	my colleagues, and what each of them owns
notes/	meeting notes, voice memos, raw capture
initiatives/	one folder per active project
processes/	how recurring things actually get done

 COPY THE FULL PROMPT

1 Six folders and a README

me · team · notes · initiatives · processes · contacts, plus the rules written down so the agent follows them without being reminded.

2 Three questions, then it goes reading

Who you are, who you work with, what you own this quarter. Then it researches your company on the web and writes me/ and team/.

3 Two notes to query straight away

This workshop, and the person giving it. Enough material that superpower 01 has something real to answer from.

4 A test it has to pass

It ends by asking itself which superpower you should build first — using only your files, citing each one.



SUPERPOWER 01

Ask your brain anything

Answers built from your own files, with the sources attached.





— SUPERPOWER 01 • WHAT IT IS

Ask **your own records**, not the internet

BY HAND, TODAY

- You remember a decision was made, but not where it was written down.
- You search Slack, then mail, then the drive, then give up and ask someone.
- You answer from memory, and hope memory is right.



ONCE THE SKILL EXISTS

- ◆ You ask a question in plain language, against your own files.
- ◆ The answer comes back with the exact files it was built from.
- ◆ You can open every one of them and check before you speak.

WHAT IT NEEDS

nothing new — the folder you just filled



— SUPERPOWER 01 · SEE IT

Every decision comes with its **sources**

- > Should we renew the GPU contract or switch providers?

Renew six months, move the batch tier to a cheaper region in Q1. No latency risk.

`infra strategy` `14-month cost analysis` `vendor notes`

- > Prepare my notes for the 1:1 with Tomas.

Three items still open from last time, two blockers he raised on Slack, one promotion case to answer.

`last meeting notes` `pending items` `project status`

- > Write a development plan for Marco.

Six-month plan built on his last three reviews. Two strengths to lean on, one gap to close.

`3 quarters of reviews` `skill matrix` `1:1 history`

- > What do we actually know about this prospect?

Evaluated us in March, walked away on latency, reopened last week. Here is what changed since.

`CRM` `support threads` `meeting history`

- ◆ This is not a chatbot guessing from the public internet. **It is my own record, and every line can be traced back to the file it came from.**



— SUPERPOWER 01 · RUN IT NOW

Same files, same questions, **everybody at once.**

your second-brain folder · ask, do not build

> What are the six superpowers, and which one should I build first?

SHOULD CITE `notes/.../AI Summit Barcelona.md`

> Who is Maxime Gaudin, and what has he worked on?

SHOULD CITE `contacts/maxime-gaudin.md`

> What am I responsible for this quarter, and who do I need for it? |

SHOULD CITE `me/context.md · team/`

Compare with the person next to you. Same files, same question, near-identical answers — and both traceable. Nothing about this is magic, which is exactly the point.

1 It names the file

Every claim should arrive with the file it came from. An answer with no filename is a guess wearing a suit.

2 It refuses when it cannot know

Ask it something that is nowhere in your folder — last quarter's revenue, say. The correct answer is "that is not in your files", not a plausible number.

3 Then make it yours

Drop three real work files into notes/ — a meeting note, a spec, a thread — and ask a question you already know the answer to. That is the whole loop, forever.



— THE OBVIOUS PROBLEM

You can query **it**. There is **almost nothing** in it.

second-brain · everything you have

README.md

me/context.md

team/ — the names you typed

notes/ — one conference note

contacts/ — one person you met

FIVE FILES · ABOUT FOUR MINUTES OF YOUR LIFE

NOT CONNECTED



Mail

Years of threads. Most of what you agreed to is in here.



Chat

Where decisions actually get made, and almost never written down.



Calendar

Who you spend your time with, and what it was supposedly about.



Meeting recorder

What was said, not what you remember being said.



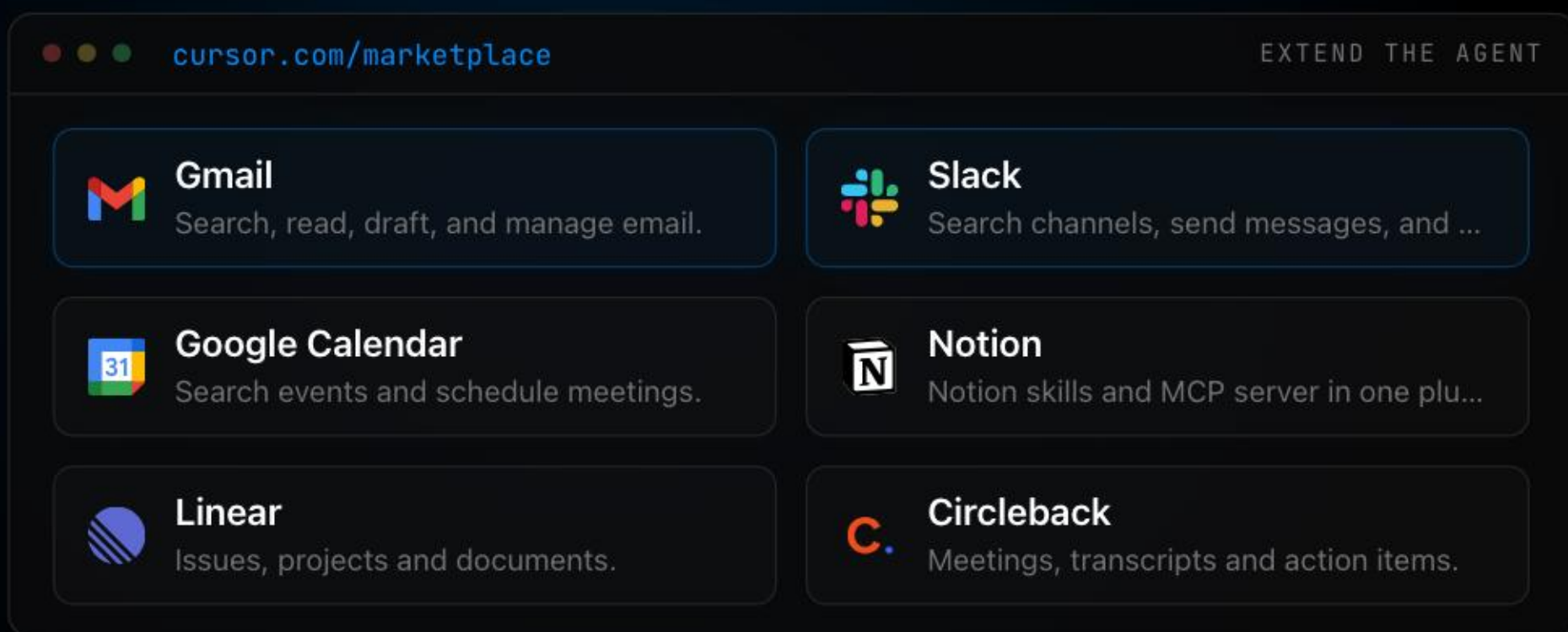
Projects and docs

What the team is doing while you are in meetings.



— LAPTOPS OPEN

Connect **as many** sources **as you can**.



Granola, Fireflies, Otter, Zoom, Teams, Outlook, GitHub, Jira, HubSpot — if your team uses it, there is a good chance it is in there. Two connected sources beat six half-configured ones.

- 1 Open the marketplace**
cursor.com/marketplace, or the Marketplace entry in the sidebar.
Several hundred plugins; you need two or three.
- 2 Start where your decisions live**
Mail and chat first, calendar second. A meeting recorder if you have one. Everything else is a bonus.
- 3 Read what you are granting**
An OAuth approval in the browser, scopes listed. On a work laptop some will be blocked — that is IT, not a bug.
- 4 Stop when the timer stops**
One connected source is enough for what we build next. You can add the rest tonight, and the skill will not need rewriting.



— BEFORE WE BUILD ON IT

Prove the connection **is live.**

pick the one for a source you actually connected

 > Summarise the last five emails I received. One line each.

PASSES IF real senders, real subjects

 > What did I miss in Slack since yesterday?

PASSES IF channels you actually belong to

 > What is on my calendar tomorrow, and who is in each meeting? |

PASSES IF names you recognise

Nothing is being written to your folder yet — this is read-only, and it costs you fifteen seconds. Do it now rather than debugging it in four slides' time.

-  **It asks you to paste them in**
Then it cannot see the tool. Quit Cursor and reopen it — the tool list is read once, at startup.
-  **It says it has no access**
The plugin installed but the approval never completed. Open it again in the marketplace and finish the browser step.
-  **It answers, and the names are real**
That is the whole test. You now have a folder the agent can write into, and live sources it can read from.



CHECKPOINT

Half an hour in, here is **what you own.**



A second brain that exists

One folder on your own machine, with a README that tells the agent how to use it.

`~/second-brain/`



That answers questions

You asked it about this talk and about me, and it cited the file it read for each answer.

`answers with sources`



Wired into the tools you actually use

Not a demo account and not sample data. Your mail, your chat, your calendar.



And it takes on new tools as you go

Whatever you adopt next is one install away from being part of the same brain.

`cursor.com/marketplace`



SUPERPOWER 02

Wake up to an empty inbox

One skill file does the triage before you open the laptop.





— SUPERPOWER 02 • WHAT IT IS

The triage happens before you wake up

BY HAND, TODAY

- You open five apps and read everything, because anything could matter.
- The urgent thing is buried between a newsletter and a calendar invite.
- An hour is gone and nothing has actually been decided.



ONCE THE SKILL EXISTS

- ◆ Everything that arrived is already filed, and the noise is already out.
- ◆ What needs you arrives as a short list, each item with its context attached.
- ◆ The rest is archived, acknowledged or drafted without you touching it.

WHAT IT NEEDS



the sources you just connected

one skill file, written once



— SUPERPOWER 02 · SEE IT

I start every day with an empty inbox

 GMAIL  SLACK  LINEAR  WHATSAPP

Nadia Brandt

Re: Q4 roadmap - can we still ship in November?

✓ REPLY DRAFTED

ACTION

Northlane

Contract renewal - we need your sign-off

✓ REPLY DRAFTED

ACTION

Tomas

1:1 tomorrow - anything you want on the agenda?

✓ REPLY DRAFTED

ACTION

UNREAD THIS MORNING



INBOX ZERO

Ten minutes.
Done.

◆ The agent removes the noise so your brain only meets what needs it. You get this exact skill today. Run it tomorrow morning.



One file. Everything that arrived, handled.

.cursor/skills/daily-routine/SKILL.md

287 LINES · SCROLL

```
name: daily-routine
description: Execute the daily communication routine – sync every source
into the brain, triage the inbox, process messages, handle the calendar,
reach Inbox Zero. Use when the user asks to run their daily routine,
check their inbox, do their morning triage, or reach Inbox Zero.
```

Daily Routine

Orchestrate the daily communication triage across every connected

This is the one I actually run. It took **months of arguing with it.**

/create-skill → paste → then type "run my daily routine"

 COPY THE DAILY-ROUTINE SKILL

07:41 · agent session

\$ run my daily routine

sync	2 meetings, 4 notes written	FILED
 calendar	4 today, 1 needs prep	FLAGGED
 gmail	128 in, 96 were noise	ARCHIVED
 gmail	32 left, 6 need you	DRAFTED
 slack	3 open threads	DRAFTED
todo	3 actionable, 2 waiting	+3 TASKS

inbox zero 9 minutes, 6 drafts waiting for you

\$

◆ Take mine as it is, tune it over a month. **Then start deleting the lines you never needed.**



SUPERPOWER 03

Produce documents and decks

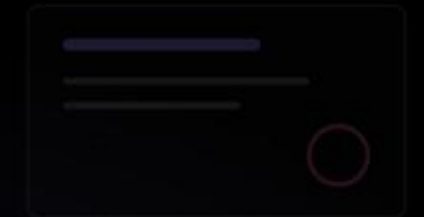
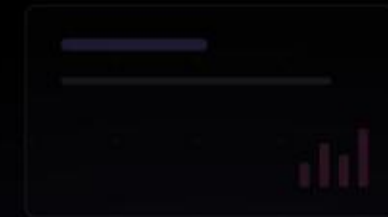
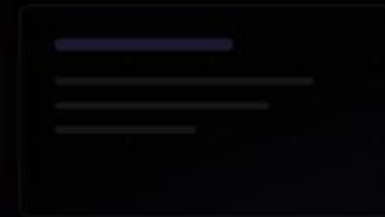
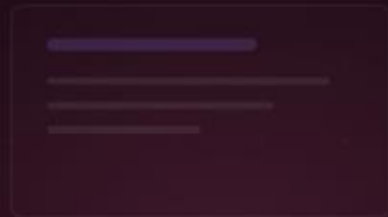
Gather the sources, approve them, and only then write a word.





— SUPERPOWER 03 • WHAT IT IS

This presentation was built by my **second brain**



YOU ARE LOOKING AT IT

30+

presentations built this way
in ten months

~2h

to produce a full
company roadmap deck

0

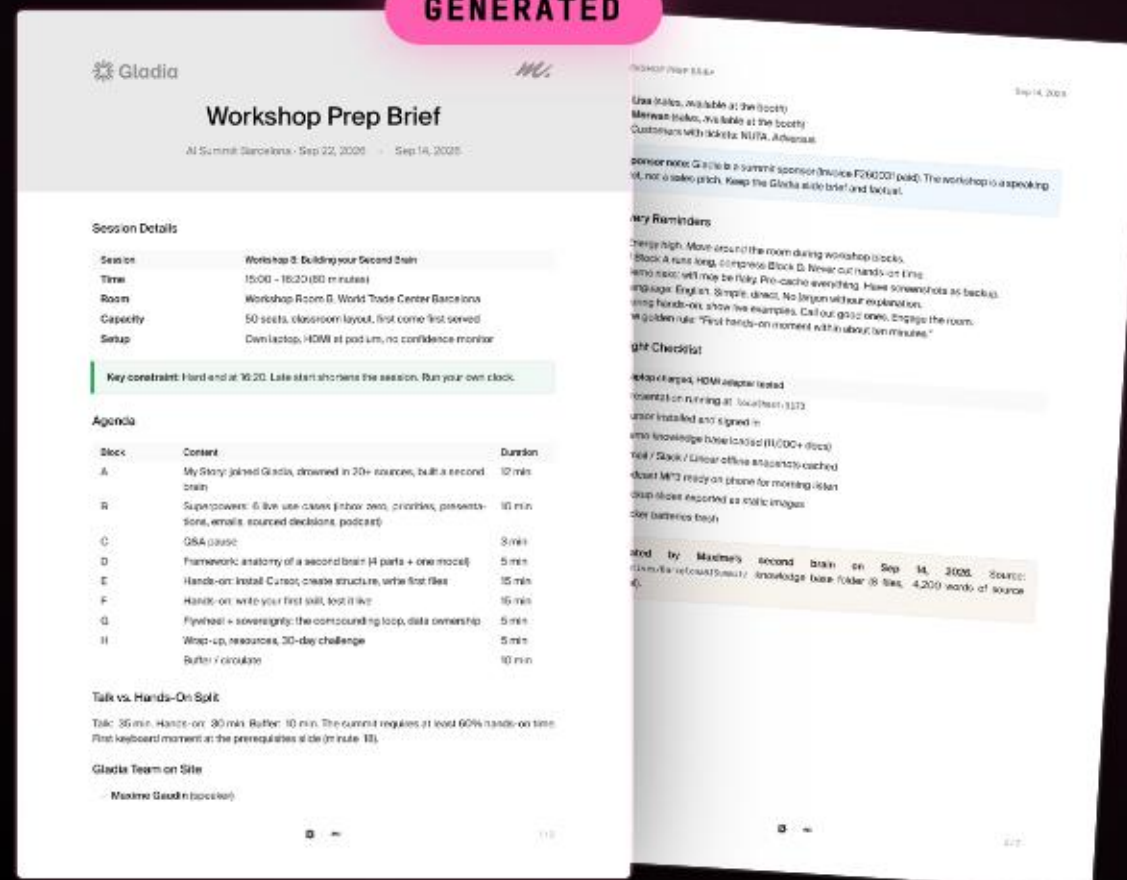
lines copy-pasted
from an old deck



SUPERPOWER 03 • SEE IT

A document, from my knowledge base

GENERATED



THE PROMPT

"Generate a prep brief for my Barcelona workshop. Pull everything from my knowledge base."

SOURCE

8 files from initiatives/BarcelonaAISummit/

FORMAT

Markdown to Typst to PDF

TIME

~4 seconds to generate

PAGES

2



One skill turns markdown into a document

.cursor/skills/to-pdf/SKILL.md

187 LINES • SCROLL

name: to-pdf

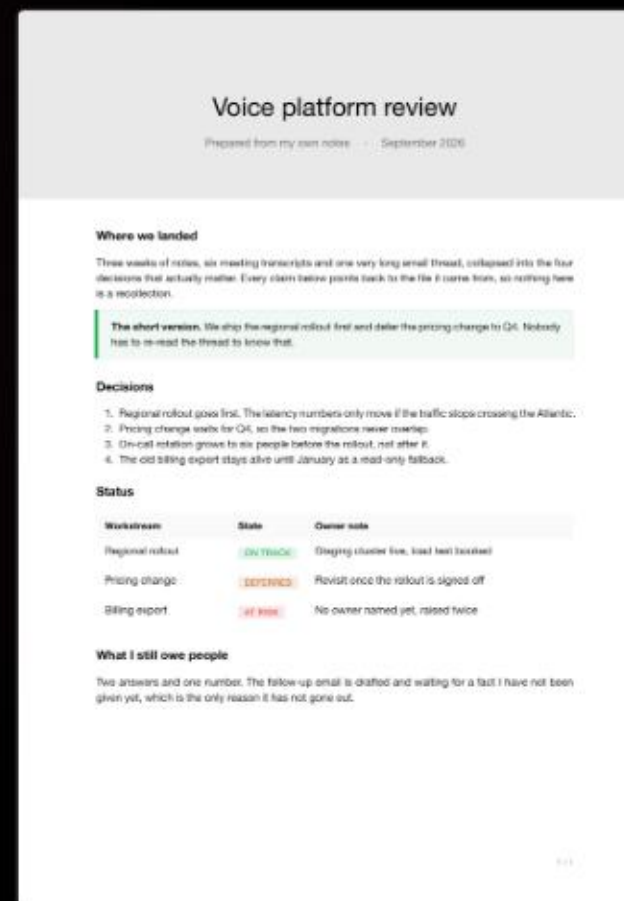
description: Convert a markdown document to a polished PDF using Typst. Use when the user asks to generate a PDF, export to PDF, make a document printable, or wants a clean PDF version of a markdown file.

Markdown to PDF

Convert markdown documents to polished, well-designed PDFs using Typst.

THEN TYPE THIS

> Turn that brief into a PDF.



SAMPLE OUTPUT

COVER BAND

Title, subtitle and date. Your logo if you add one.

CALLOUT

One box for the answer, so nobody has to read to find it.

STATUS BADGES

Colour-coded, inside tables, written as plain markdown.

Diagrams too: it renders your Mermaid blocks to vector and sizes them to the page.



— SUPERPOWER 03 · BUILD IT · 2 OF 2

🔄 second-brain-starter/skills/dynamic-presentation/SKILL.md

The other one turns markdown into **this**

.cursor/skills/dynamic-presentation/SKILL.md 527 LINES · SCROLL

```
name: dynamic-presentation
description: Build animated HTML presentations using React,
TypeScript, Vite, and GSAP. Use when the user asks for an animated
presentation, HTML slides, dynamic deck, interactive presentation,
or wants to create/edit a React-based slide deck.
```

Dynamic Presentation

Creates animated, full-screen presentations as modular React + TypeScript apps with GSAP animations and hash-based navigation.

THEN TYPE THIS

> Make that a deck instead. |

SUPERPOWER 03 · SEE IT

Built from the **same notes**

0+

DECKS, TEN MONTHS

● SAMPLE OUTPUT · RUNNING LIVE, NOT A SCREENSHOT



CHAPTER 03

Three Things That Help

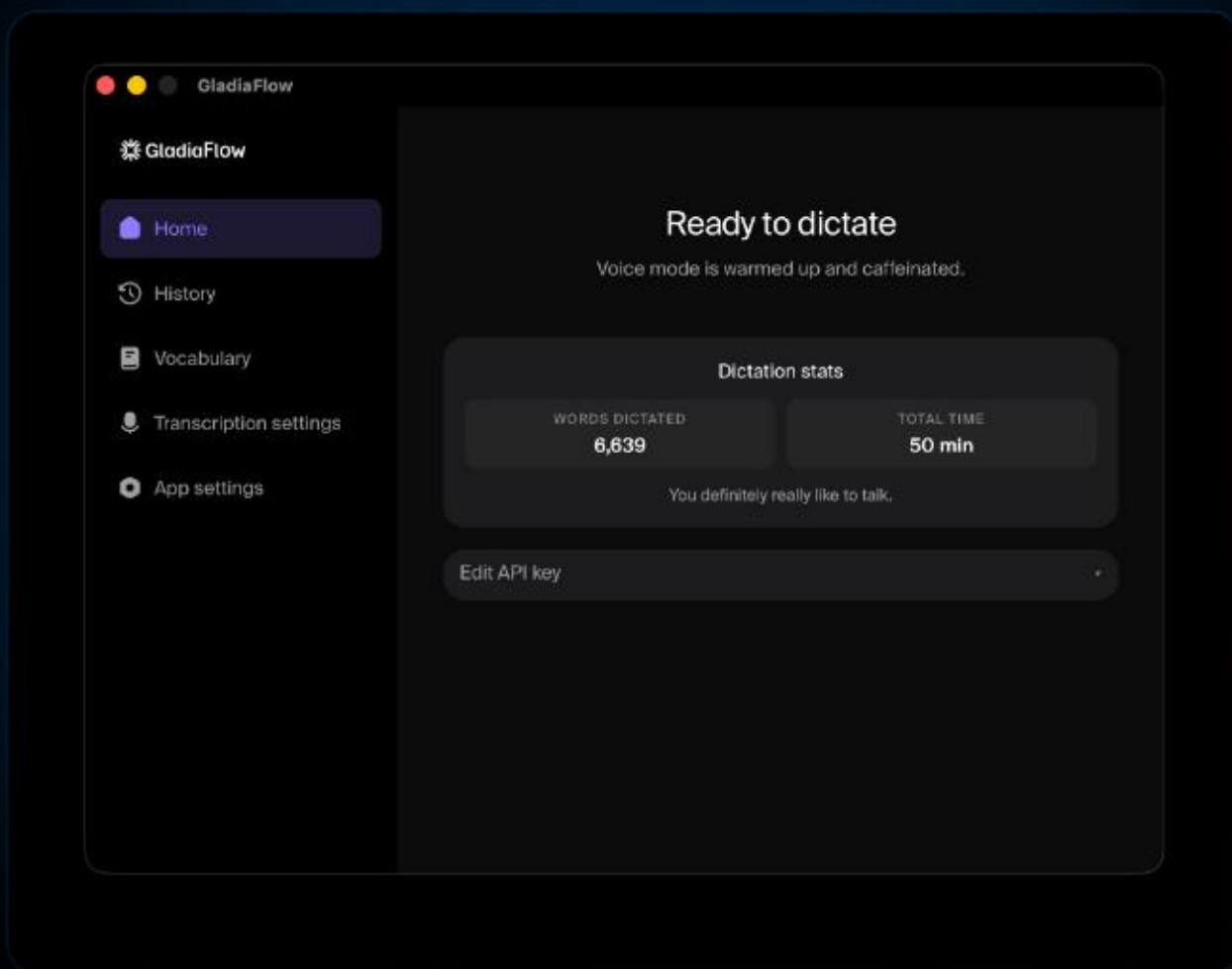
How to talk to it, what the files you have been pasting actually are, and which ones to steal.





— THE HABIT THAT MAKES ALL OF THIS STICK

From here on, you **talk to your machine** a lot more.



- **Typing is about to become the slow part**
Every note, every skill, every correction is you writing to a machine. The thinking was never the bottleneck.
- **It works everywhere, not just in the editor**
If your keyboard can type into it, you can dictate into it. 
- **100+ languages, switching mid-sentence**
And you can teach it your names, your acronyms and your product vocabulary, so it stops mangling them.

 gladia.io/gladiflow open source · MIT · pay per use

Full disclosure: my team builds this one. Any dictation tool does the job — Wispr Flow and the macOS built-in both work.



— HANDS OFF THE KEYBOARD FOR A MINUTE

[second-brain-starter/skills/](#)

A skill is a **text file**. That is the whole trick.

`.cursor/skills/your-skill/SKILL.md`

meeting follow-up

When I paste meeting notes:

1. extract the decisions
2. list action items + owners
3. add them to my todo list
4. draft the follow-up messages
5. save it all in notes/

NO CODE



Meeting follow-up

Extract the decisions, update the todo, draft the follow-up messages.



Weekly status

Read the week, then write the update your manager actually reads.



New contact

Capture who you met, why it matters, and what you owe them next.



Presentation builder

Gather the sources, then build the deck. This one built these slides.

◆ A skill teaches the AI to work *your* way. **Same task, different person, different file.**

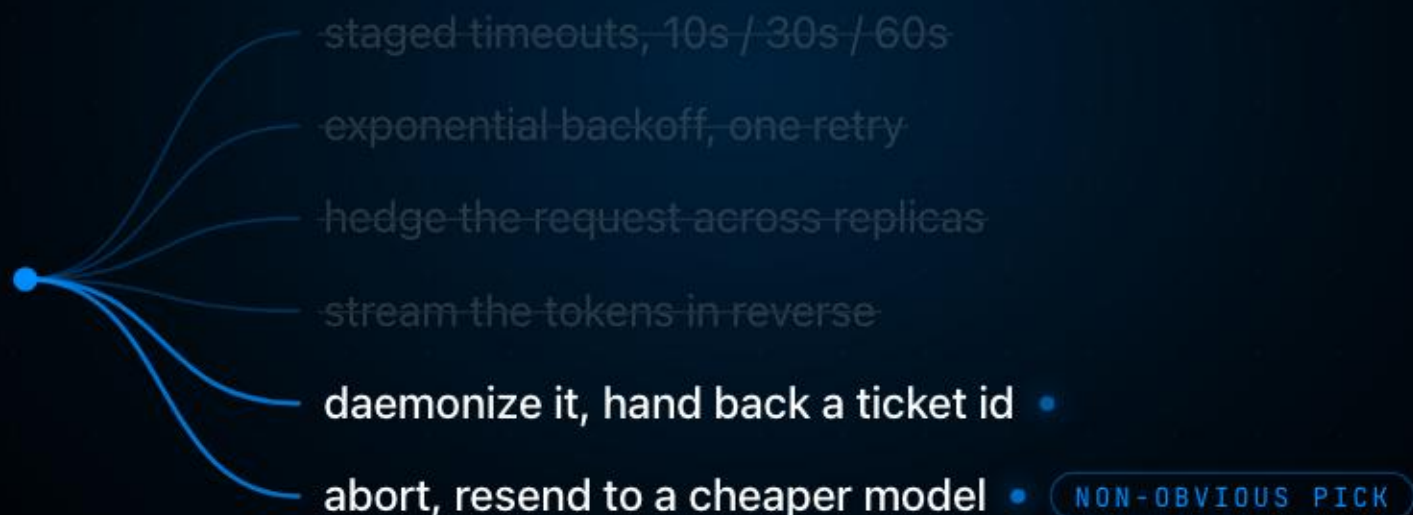


— TWO I DID NOT WRITE

Other people's skills work in your brain too

adhd github.com/UditAkhouri/adhd

Asks the question six ways at once, then throws five answers away.



```
$ npx skills add UditAkhouri/adhd
```

caveman github.com/JuliusBrussee/caveman

Same answer, a quarter of the words. Your agent stops clearing its throat.

BEFORE · 69 TOKENS

The reason your React component is re-rendering is likely because you're creating a new object reference on each render cycle. When you pass an inline object as a prop, React's shallow comparison sees it as a different object every time, which triggers a re-render. I'd recommend using `useMemo` to memoize the object.

AFTER · 19 TOKENS

New object ref each render. Inline object prop = new ref = re-render. Wrap in `useMemo`.

```
$ npx skills add JuliusBrussee/caveman -g
```

◆ A skill is a file, so good ones travel. **I use both of these every day, and I wrote neither.**



CHAPTER 04

Common Caveats

What breaks when you do this on your own, and the one line that fixes each.





— BEFORE YOU GO AND DO THIS ALONE

Seven things that will go wrong. **And the fix.**

01 "It doesn't sound like me."

Write your voice down once, in one file, and have every skill that writes read it.

03 "It got it wrong again."

Fix the skill, never the answer. A corrected answer is gone tomorrow; a corrected skill is not.

05 "It did something I didn't ask for."

Draft, never send. Put that line in every skill that can reach another human being.

02 "It made something up."

Make citation mandatory. If a claim is not in a file, the honest answer is "I don't know".

04 "My folder is still empty."

It is only as good as what you put in it. Capture after every meeting or it dies in a week.

06 "My company blocks the connectors."

Start local. Your notes and documents alone already pay for the whole thing.

07 "I don't know how to do this."

Ask the thing. It knows this stack better than I do and it has infinite patience.



— CAVEAT 01 · "IT DOESN'T SOUND LIKE ME"

second-brain-starter/me/tone-of-voice.md

Teach it your tone **once**. Reuse it forever.

me/tone-of-voice.md

15 LINES · SCROLL

How I write

This file is the only place my voice is defined. Every skill that writes something for me points here.

Rewrite all of it. The lines below are mine, not yours – they are here to show the level of detail that actually changes the output.

Short sentences. One idea each.

- Decision first, reasoning after. Never the reverse.

DO NOT HAVE THIS FILE. YOU WILL BE REPEATING BACK. NO ONE.

↳ `.cursor/skills/daily-routine/SKILL.md`

Write it in the voice described in me/tone-of-voice.md

① Write the file on the left. It is the only place your voice lives.

② Rewrite every line to sound like you, not like me.

③ Add that one reference line to any skill that writes on your behalf.

THEN TYPE THIS

> Draft my reply to the latest thread with @person. |



— CAVEAT 02 · "IT MADE SOMETHING UP."

A claim with no file behind it is **not an answer.**

WHAT IT TOLD ME

Churn was 4.1% last quarter, up from 3.4%.

Two of the three churned accounts named latency.

~~The competition is winning on price.~~

WHERE IT COMES FROM

company/metrics/q2-review.md

support/threads/2026-06.md

nothing

SO IT SAYS **"I don't know. Nothing in your files says that."**

◆ One line in the README does it: every claim names the file it came from. **A brain that can say "I don't know" is worth ten that cannot.**



— CAVEAT 03 · "IT GOT IT WRONG AGAIN."

Fix the skill, **not its answer.**

YOU FIX THE ANSWER



The correction lived in a chat window, and the chat window is gone.

YOU FIX THE SKILL



The correction lives in a file, and the file is still there in March.

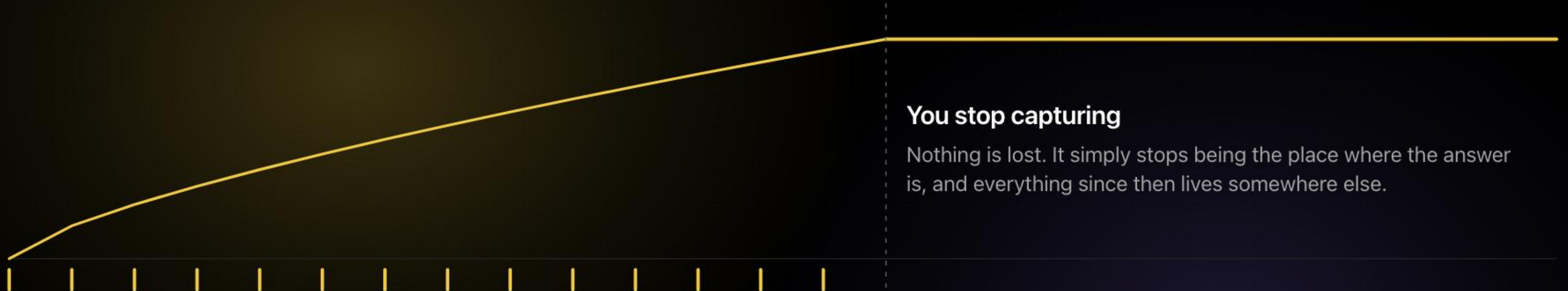
◆ Correcting the output feels faster and buys you exactly one day. **Correcting the file is the only edit that is still there next week.**



— CAVEAT 04 · "MY FOLDER IS STILL EMPTY."

It is worth **exactly what you put in it.**

HOW OFTEN YOU REACH FOR IT



One tick is one meeting written down, one decision noted, one document dropped in the folder.

You stop capturing

Nothing is lost. It simply stops being the place where the answer is, and everything since then lives somewhere else.

◆ This never dies from bad tooling. **It dies from a week of not writing anything down.**



— CAVEAT 05 · "IT DID SOMETHING I DIDN'T ASK FOR."

Draft, **never send.**

DRAFT

To: procurement@acme.com
Re: renewal terms

Happy to move ahead at the discount
we discussed on Thursday.

Send

 not the agent's to press

YOU

Sent

Reached only by a hand on a keyboard, every single time.

Always draft. Never send. I press the button.

Put that line in every skill that can reach another human being. **The agent writes at machine speed. Pressing the button stays a human decision.**



— CAVEAT 06 · "MY COMPANY BLOCKS THE CONNECTORS."

Start on **your side of the wall.**

Every meeting you record

Every note and decision you write down

Every document anyone sends you

Everything you have already written

None of this needs anybody's permission, and it is already more context than any colleague has about your work.

WHAT IT WILL NOT OPEN



Gmail

NO ACCESS



Slack

NO ACCESS



Calendar

NO ACCESS



Notion

NO ACCESS

- ◆ Two of the four things you built today never touched a connector. **Ask for access once you can show what it is already doing for you.**



— CAVEAT 07 · "I DON'T KNOW HOW TO DO THIS."

Ask it. That is the entire answer.

THINGS WORTH ASKING OUT LOUD

> How do I connect

You are sitting next to the best teacher you will get for this.

It has read the documentation for every tool in this room, it has infinite patience, and the worst it can do is hand you an answer you correct in one sentence.



CHAPTER 05

Where This Goes

One connector at a time, it compounds. And where to pick it all back up tomorrow.

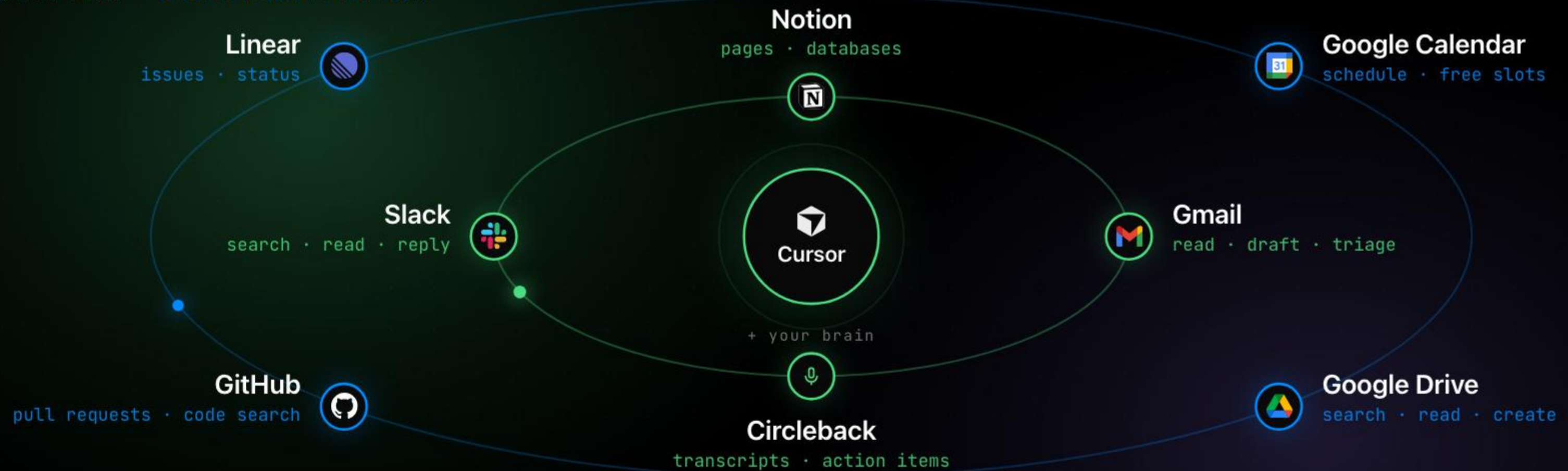




— WHAT TO DO AFTER TODAY

Every tool you connect is **one more superpower.**

● INSTALLED TODAY ○ EVERYTHING AFTER TODAY





THE FLYWHEEL

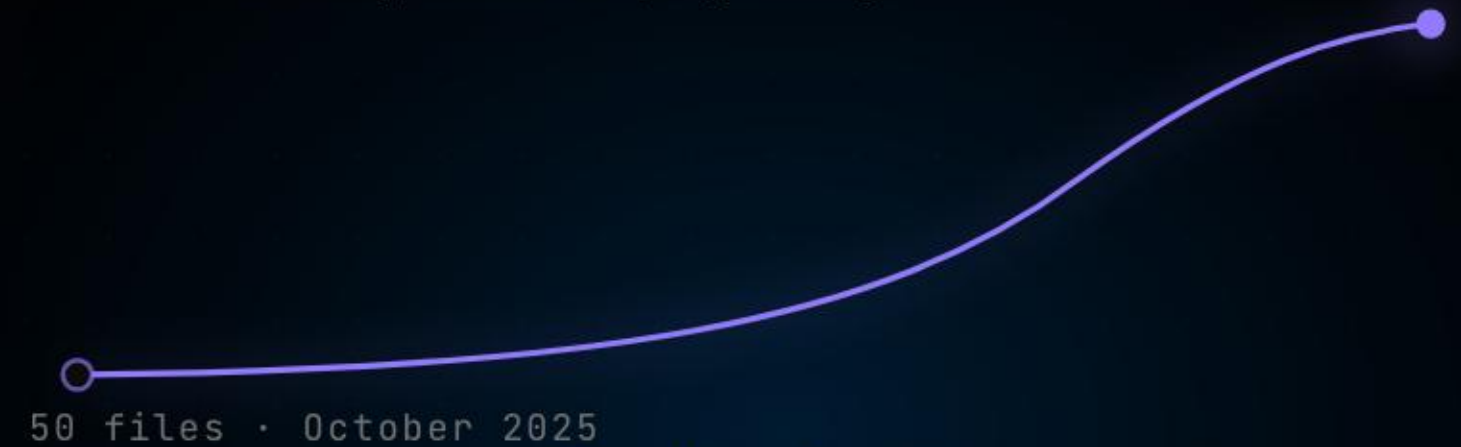
The More You Feed It, The Smarter It Gets



MY KNOWLEDGE BASE · 11 MONTHS

11,000+

documents today, and it keeps growing



One file a day. Thirty days. That is the whole method.

- ◆ You own all of it. Plain files on your own machine. No lock-in, no subscription. **If the tool disappears tomorrow, your markdown still opens.**



AI SUMMIT BARCELONA 2026

Thank you.

Every skill we wrote today is in one repository. Take it, rewrite it, make it sound like you.

[**github.com/MaximeGaudin/second-brain-starter**](https://github.com/MaximeGaudin/second-brain-starter)

Maxime "MadMax" Gaudin
CTO, Gladia





— ONLY IF THE CLOCK IS KIND

Now you pick. **We build it live.**

```
.cursor/skills/????/SKILL.md
```

```
---
```

```
name: weekly-stat
```

```
description:
```

```
---
```

```
#
```

01 **Somebody names a chore**

Something you did three times this week and resented every time.

02 **We say what done looks like**

Out loud, in one sentence. If we cannot, the skill is not ready to write.

03 **We write the file together**

/create-skill, then the steps, in your words, on this screen.

04 **We run it on something real**

It gets something wrong. We fix the file, not the answer.